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Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

VENTURES VOYAGE

TO BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS

TALES OF PASSION, PERSISTENCE, AND PURPOSE

November 2024

ENTREPRENEURSHIP: Where risk meets reward and vision becomes impact

Welcome to this month's Founder's Spotlight, where we take you into the stories and insights of visionary founders who have taken a leap into entrepreneurship. We reached out to entrepreneurs who have graciously shared their journeys; from the sparks that ignited their passion to the challenges they faced and conquered on the way ahead.

Such realities of building from the ground up reveal the raw insights into the choices that brought them to entrepreneurship over pursuing a traditional career path. They faced highs and lows along the way, learning not only business strategies but important lessons regarding personal development, leadership, and adaptability. Their stories are proof that while rarely straight or smooth, the road to entrepreneurship is often most rewarded when you have the courage to follow your passion and carve out your own path. If you are an emerging entrepreneur or interested in knowing what makes up the startup community, then this edition is full of insights and real world wisdom to fuel your journey. So come along with us as we tell the stories of entrepreneurs who stepped out from their comfort zones and brought ideas to life and discover how you can learn from them to fuel your own entrepreneurial vision.

SUSHMITA POOJARI
MBA FINANCE

Priyadarshan Sahasrabuddhe: A Journey of Sustainable Innovation and Renewable Energy Leadership

Welcome to this month's Founder's Spotlight, where we take you into the stories and insights of visionary founders who have taken a leap into entrepreneurship. We reached out to entrepreneurs who have graciously shared their journeys; from the sparks that ignited their passion to the challenges they faced and conquered on the way ahead. His Inspiration traces back to his college days when he watched The Inconvenient Truth, a documentary that opened his eyes to the pressing environmental crisis.

Priyadarshan Sahasrabudde
Founder Vaayu

Driven to make a difference, he sought practical ways to address waste management, eventually meeting Mr. Anand Karve, a prominent advocate for biogas technology. Karve introduced him to the world of biogas as a renewable energy source, sparking Sahastrabuddhe's interest in what he terms "True Engineering"- innovative solutions that address real-world problems.

Guided by the philosophy of Small-Slow-Grow, Sahasrabudde built Vaayu as a business focused on sustainable growth. He views entrepreneurship as a medium for problem-solving, which allows for flexibility in tackling challenges. His primary goal is to integrate waste elimination and alternative fuel solutions within a realistic business framework, overcoming limitations and embracing the opportunities presented by renewable energy.

Sahastrabuddhe believes that the future of entrepreneurship lies in renewable energy. According to him," If you can create an efficient solution, there will always be a market for it." His advice to future entrepreneurs is clear: "Look around with open eyes. If something doesn't align with a sustainable world, apply your energy and knowledge to change it. It's immensely fulfilling to address the biggest challenges of our time."

"Look around with open eyes. If something doesn't align with a sustainable world, apply your energy and knowledge to change it. It's immensely fulfilling to address the biggest challenges of our time."

Nishant Inamdar
MBA IB

Building Om Multi-Specialist: Dr. Punjabi's Path to Success

Dr. Mayur Punjabi, founder of Om Multispecialty Hospital, chose the challenging path of entrepreneurship over a traditional career. His journey is full of determination and passion and is an inspiration to aspiring entrepreneurs. In a recent interview, Dr. Punjabi shared his motivation, competitiveness and common sense at the Aspiring Entrepreneur Forum. Dr. Punjabi's passion for entrepreneurship stems from the desire to impact the well-being of the people.

Working in the hospital, he realised the opportunity for innovation and growth. He expressed "Opening Om General Hospital allowed him to work more efficiently, use his ideas, and as a result, his job satisfaction increased." The healthcare industry has a huge untapped potential. Starting his own business gave him the freedom to fill this gap and provide solutions in a variety of areas. It's not easy. Dr. Punjabi has faced many challenges, from complex regulations to securing capital. "It has been a tough 10-year journey," he admits. Raising funds to support the organisation's growth and operations has also proven to be a constant challenge. Despite these challenges, he remains focused on his vision and learns from every failure. Dr. Punjabi believes that healthcare offers ample opportunity for new entrepreneurs. He highlighted areas such as medical consulting, opening medical stores, and hospital management. "The healthcare sector is expanding rapidly and requires new thinking and new solutions," he said. "There is room for everyone who wants to invest, take loans, and find talented teams."

Dr. Punjabi emphasised the importance of education, adult learning, and perseverance even when things seem difficult, Good people and religious groups are important. Promote them, be patient and focus on your goals. Punjabis admit that the early stages are taxing on the brain. Social expectations and self-doubt are often problems. However, he is still determined, has a clear vision and is focused on solving problems.

His advice to young entrepreneurs is: "Work hard, expand your knowledge as much as possible and gather ideas to make a meaningful difference. Analysing diversity and staying focused on your goals are the keys to long-term success." Dr. Punjabi's journey from being a physician to the successful founder of Om Multispeciality Hospital is a testament to the power of dedication. His insights offer invaluable advice to anyone who dreams of making an impact through business.

Priyanka Nagar
FY MBA IB - A

WORDS THAT INSPIRE: HOW A PASSION FOR WRITING BECAME A PURPOSE-DRIVEN BUSINESS

Ms. Riya Gote has revealed that both her inclination toward writing and the ability of words motivated her to establish a company in the year 2019. She is from a Maharashtrian family and she used to think of writing only as a leisure activity but later found her calling to share and in turn gain knowledge which propelled her pursuits at Scriberlee

It is an uphill task, maintaining a healthy relationship between work and personal life mainly because there are lots of trips to be made either to Singapore or Pune often.

To cope, however, Ms. Gote sets limits, for instance, no work-related phone calls are attended after 8 PM unless it is an emergency. She believes in her team and provides time for her growth, adhering to healthy practices, taking the necessary respite, and following a sabbatical each year.

In any case, looking back at her journey, she thinks she should have been more adventurous in the beginning since she was timid and cautious. In the course of time, she worked on the growth of Scriberlee and took on the challenges. In terms of leadership skills, she is an empathetic, genuine, and nurturing person, especially towards the younger generation, but does not see herself in their position – rather, she sees herself in a more supportive role.

For Ms. Gote, adopting the entrepreneur's mantle has fostered inner strength, trust in self, and 'real self.' She tells her young entrepreneur audiences – 'don't forget to have faith in yourself, do not just chase money-based purpose in life, and positive people should be around you.' Her stance on time, attitude, and obsession with knowledge is clear. She understands that success should not be celebrated, as it only hinders progress; rather, 'attempts should be made to advance oneself beyond that, as there is a lot more to achieve.'

MANALI KHADILKAR
FY MBA HR- A

Embracing Freedom and Passion: Building a Unique Brand on Your Own Terms

Starting your own business is a chance to create something unique while working on your own terms. It's a break from the typical 9-to-5 routine, giving you the flexibility to work on projects you love, set your own hours, and explore other interests outside of work. CS Mr.Ishan Sir Partner at Lexagon Corplegal Services LLP, took this path in his career and is a self made Successful entrepreneur. He further added, by spotting the gaps in the market early on, you can get an advantage over the competition. Plus, it opens doors to meet new people, exchange ideas, and get a fresh perspective on how to run a business.

Building a solid network and a loyal client base is key, along with keeping up-to-date on rules and regulations, managing cash flow, and finding a good work-life balance. Being a successful entrepreneur he emphasized on how important it is to maintain work-life balance by prioritizing everything according to the requirement. He talked about how important it is to understand areas like (ESG), intellectual property, and corporate governance that can make your business stronger in the long run.

These are few areas where the Budding entrepreneurs can explore opportunities and establish their own start-ups and add up to the growth and development of a nation and also grow as an individual. Lastly Mr.Ishan mentioned that it is very prime to believe in embracing the challenges, staying patient, being consistent and staying honest and true to your business and profession.

LEXAGON™

WORDS OF ADVICE BY
MR. ISHAN PADHYE

Remember, every successful company started as just an idea with a lot of passion behind it. Trust your vision, stay steady, connect with the right people, and don't be afraid to push limits. Stay curious, work with integrity, and keep moving forward to make your mark on the world.

Vedashree Ganesh Ghotkar
MBA HR A

SAKSHAM REWARI : A JOURNEY FROM IDEA TO IDEAGATOR

Mr. Saksham Rewari, co-founder of Ideagator has had an exceptional journey switching careers from a corporate employee to a full-time entrepreneur. His passion for creating a reality that is creative and can be silly and serious concurrently gave birth to Ideagator - a marketing agency with the notion of - working like an

MNC while providing affordability like a startup and not compromising with the quality of the project. The transition from a full time employee to an entrepreneur kicked in during the pandemic when the entire world was heading on its way to a digital world. He believes being an entrepreneur has its challenges of working from 9 to 5 to always working 24/7. The evolution of being an own boss has an everyday challenge of leading a team and finding the right balance between the roles of a friend and teacher. Some of the significant challenges he faces as an entrepreneur are hiring the right people and targeting the niche audience, being flexible and adapting to the audience, self-employment and constantly getting the business.

HIS KEY ADVICE FOR BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS :

MR. SAKSHAM REWARI

"Understanding why you want to do it", In today's world it is "Survival of the Freshest" – being a magnet for learning and adaptability. And " Turning uncertainty to opportunity and taking failure as a lesson"
In conclusion, his mantra of being an entrepreneur is " Motivation is cheap while self-discipline is expensive."

Sanjana Kashyap
HR - B

DARING TO SUCCEED

-NEERAJ MUNJAL'S STORY

After working in one industry for 2 decades, the decision to start a business is bold and challenging. For many people, leaving a steady job is frightening, but some reach a point where opportunity for growth and new experiences are thrilling. This was true for Mr. Neeraj Munjal who started his own business, Authentic Packaging Pvt. Ltd. in 2012, focusing on using food-grade Post-Consumer Recycled (PCR) materials in plastic products, setting new industry standards for eco-friendly solutions.

Prior to Authentic Packaging, He worked in notable businesses such as Padmini Polymers, My Pack Polymers, and Hitech Corporation. Since the onset of his Business, they've expanded their factory to Gujarat and now export products to Dubai, USA, and Bahrain.

Authentic Packaging Pvt Ltd.
Providing flexibility imparting innovations

Launching a new business with no formal background is no easy feat. Securing right licenses, Hiring right people without an HR team and acquiring funds for the business required a steep learning curve.

Financial difficulties during market slowdown added to the hurdles, which every entrepreneur should be ready to face. With entrepreneurs emerging every day, he emphasized that consistency is the key to success. We live in a country with a vast and diverse consumer base of 1.4 billion people, making the opportunities for growth virtually limitless. However, keeping track of market dynamics and understanding market needs and trends and being adaptable are essential for long term success.

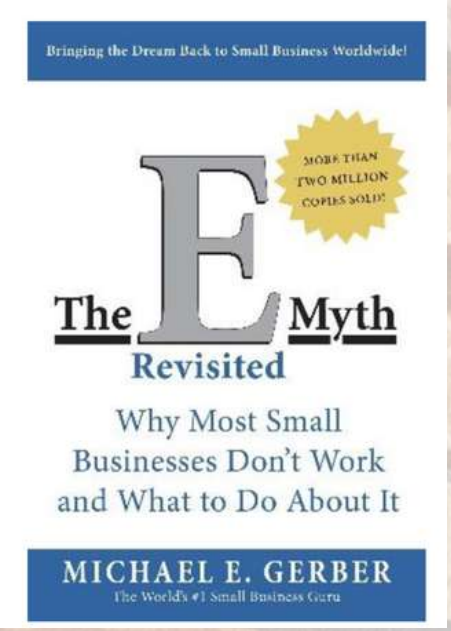
He recommended reading books on strategic growth, business analysis, and the philosophies of successful business leaders, as they offer valuable insights for business success. Learning about business plans can provide the difference between a great idea and a successful business.

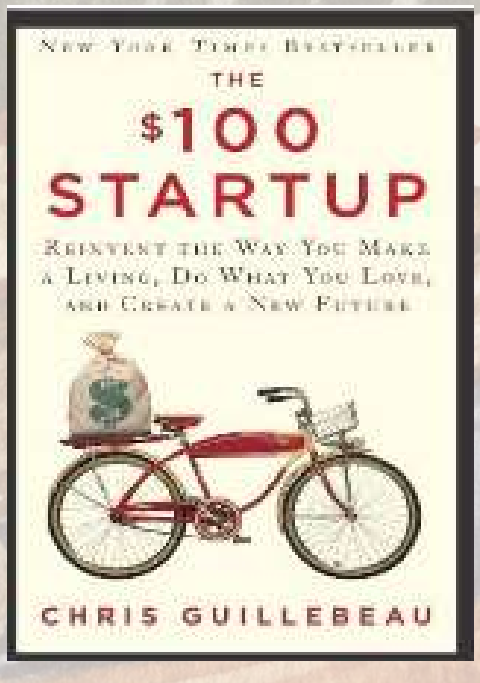
Mr. Neeraj Munjal's Journey highlights the importance of persistence, adaptability, commitment to growth and stepping out of our comfort zone which shows us that successful business is quite within reach.

VARAD MULGUND
FY MBA BA

SUGGESTION BOX(BOOKS)

"The E-Myth Revisited" by Michael E. Gerber teaches entrepreneurs to focus on building systems and processes, rather than getting bogged down in daily tasks. Gerber advocates for treating a business like a franchise, where it can run smoothly without constant owner involvement, ensuring long-term success and scalability.





"The $100 Startup" by Chris Guillebeau offers practical advice for starting a business with minimal investment. Through case studies, Guillebeau shows that it is possible to turn a small idea into a successful venture with creativity, passion, and smart marketing. The book emphasizes leveraging skills and resources you already have to create a profitable business, without the need for a large upfront investment. It inspires readers to take action and pursue entrepreneurial opportunities.

SUGGESTION BOX (COURSES)

1. Quantitative Finance & Algorithmic Trading

Offered by Coursera, edX, or Udacity

Courses in quantitative finance and algorithmic trading are great for students interested in trading, quantitative analysis, or machine learning applications in finance. They cover statistics, data analysis, and programming (often in Python or R), which are in demand in hedge funds, proprietary trading firms, and investment banks.

2.Data Science for Finance

Offered by platforms like Coursera or Udacity

Data science courses for finance are valuable, covering data analysis, machine learning, and financial data management, preparing students for roles in financial analytics, data-driven decision-making, and fintech.

Samiksha Pazare
MBA FINANCE

Success Stories of Startups

Industry: Eyewear

Lenskart was founded by Peyush Bansal, Sumeet Kapahi and Amit Chaudhary in 2010 by an ex-Microsoft 'techie' with no money but truckloads of relentless passion to make a difference in this world. Lenskart started as an online retailer for contact lenses and later expanded to include eyeglasses and sunglasses

The company revolutionised the eyewear industry in India by offering a seamless online and offline shopping experience. Lenskart's innovative services such as home eye check ups and 3D try on features are their unique selling points. The company has grown rapidly with over 1400 stores across India and a significant online presence reaching out to over 100,000 customers a month. Lenskart's success is linked with affordability, quality and customer satisfaction.

Industry: Beauty and Wellness

In 2012, Falguni Nayar founded Nykaa that has become a leading beauty and wellness e-commerce platform in India. Initially it was an online exclusive store but today it has expanded to an omnichannel model with physical stores across the country.

The company offers a wide range of beauty, fashion and wellness products including their own private label. Nykaa's success is driven by its focus on authentic products, competitive pricing and a strong digital presence. The company went public in 2021 by making Falguni Nayar as one of India's richest self-made women.

Success Stories of Startups

Industry: Fantasy Sports

Dream11 is India's largest fantasy sports platform founded by Harsh Jain and Bhavit Sheth in 2008. The platform allows users to create fantasy teams for various sports including cricket, football and basketball and earn points based on the real life performance of players.

Dream11's innovative approach to fantasy sports has made it immensely popular with more than 100 million users. The company has become India's first gaming unicorn in 2019 and has secured significant investments from major venture capital firms.

Industry: Food Delivery

Swiggy, which was founded by Sriharsha Majety, Nandan Reddy and Rahul Jaimini has transformed the food delivery industry in India. Starting in 2014 with just a few delivery partners in Bengaluru,

Swiggy now operates in more than 500 cities with a vast network of restaurants and delivery personnel. The company's success is built on its efficient logistics network, user-friendly app and focus on customer satisfaction. Swiggy has also expanded into grocery delivery and other services continuously innovating to meet consumer needs.

Success Stories of Startups

Industry: Healthcare

PharmEasy was founded by Dharmil Sheth and Dr. Dhaval Shah in 2014. It is an online pharmacy and healthcare platform. The company connects patients with local pharmacies and diagnostic centres offering a wide range of healthcare products and services.

PharmEasy's user-friendly app and website make it easy for customers to online order medicines and healthcare products. The company has grown rapidly by serving millions of customers across India to lead the e-pharmacy sector.PharmEasy's user-friendly app and website make it easy for customers to online order medicines and healthcare products. The company has grown rapidly by serving millions of customers across India to lead the e-pharmacy sector.

Industry: Fintech

In 2014, Razorpay was founded by Harshil Mathur and Shashank Kumar which provides payment solutions to businesses. The platform offers a wide range of services including payment gateways, payroll management and lending solutions. Razorpay's success is driven by focusing on easy online payments for small and medium sized enterprises and startups. The company has grown significantly by processing billions of transactions and becoming one of India's most valued fintech startups.

Krishna Gutte

FY MBA HR B

CONCLUSION

The article concludes with bits of knowledge from different entrepreneurial ventures, each epitomizing an unmistakable approach to accomplishing commerce victory. It emphasizes the shifted inspirations, challenges, and triumphs that shape these entrepreneurs' ways.

- Riya Gote's story centers on her enthusiasm for composing, which she changed into a purpose-driven commerce. She values individual development, realness, and a positive mentality. Her exhortation to yearning for business people incorporates prioritizing reason over benefit, keeping up lowliness, and encompassing oneself with strong people.

- Saksham Rewari, the co-founder of Ideagator, transitioned from a corporate career to business, building a showcasing office centered on imagination and client needs. His encounter highlights versatility, flexibility, and learning from disappointments. He energizes modern business people to remain restrained, grasp alter, and see instabilities as openings.

- Priyadarshan Sahasrabuddhe's travel with Vaayu, a renewable vitality wander, underscores the significance of supportability. His work in squander administration and elective fills represents how businesses can drive natural effect. He exhorts business people to coordinate feasible hones, noticing that purpose-led development can convey long-term esteem.

CONCLUSION

●Neeraj Munjal, who leads True Bundling Pvt. Ltd., outlines the part of perseverance and eco-friendly advancement in commerce. He overcame obstacles in financing, group administration, and showcase adjustment, emphasizing consistency, flexibility, and a center on long-term objectives.

● Dr. Mayur Punjabi moved from pharmaceutical to set up Om Multispecialty Clinic, driven by a craving to make strides in healthcare. His travel stresses flexibility, ceaseless learning, and a clear vision. He prompts healthcare business people to center on development and stay goal-oriented.

● CS Ishan Padhye sees enterprise as a way to autonomy and fulfillment. He advocates for distinguishing showcase holes, building systems, and adjusting work-life elements. He too emphasizes understanding ESG (natural, social, and administration), mental property, and corporate administration. Padhye's center message is to begin with energy, keep up a vision, make shrewd associations, remain inquisitive, and endeavor for enduring effect.

In essence, these business people collectively recommend that victory lies in versatility, versatility, development, and a purpose-driven approach, empowering future business people to construct businesses that make significant effects.

Ishika Jangra
MBA HR A

RIDDLES

" I am a seed sown in darkness,
Growing from a brave spark.
I grow fast by hustle, grit, and might,
Though many strive, few of me take flight.
I'm risk and reward, stress and glee,
A journey long but held so dear to be.
With dreams to climb, I strive to soar,
What am I that so many adore?"
Answer: An Entrepreneur

I am necessary for every beginning but can be a double-edged sword. What am I?
Answer: Funding.

I am the blood of a startup, but dry up fast if not well managed. What am I?
Answer: Cash flow.

'I begin as a spark in someone's mind,
A vision, one of a kind.
With courage and risk, I come to life,
But only thrive through passion and strife.
I grow with ideas, plans, and a team,
Chasing a big, ambitious dream.
What am I, born from inspiration,
Fueling the drive of new creation?
Answer: Start-up

Garima Prasad
MBA BFS

Tapan Kajagar
MBA Finance E

Nirjala Temghare
MBA Finance E

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